

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 1, 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (d)

In the First Round Table Conference, Dr. Ambedkar demanded separate electorates for the depressed classes. The Indian National Congress participated only in the Second Round Table Conference and boycotted Third and First Round Table Conferences. In the Poona Pact, Congress agreed that adequate representation would be given to the depressed classes in local bodies and civil services. So, all three statements given in the options are correct.

Communal Award and Poona

Pact (1932)

*A consensus among several parties for the separate electorate for Dalits was not reached in Second Round Table Conference. As a result the conference authorized British P.M. Ramsay MacDonald to find a solution. * On **16th August 1932 A.D.** Ramsay MacDonald announced **Communal Award**. In this award, each minority group was given some reserved seats in legislative assemblies and elections to those seats were to be held by a **separate electorate**.

*Earlier only Muslims and Sikhs were considered minorities but with this award the Dalit section of Hindu religion also got separated from it and now considered as a minority. Now Muslims, Indian Christians, Sikhs, Anglo-Indians and others were granted separate electorates which were available in elections at Provincial Legislatures only. * Gandhiji started his first fast unto death on **20th September, 1932 A.D.** from **Yerawada jail** against the Communal Award which ended with the **Poona Pact** between **B.R. Ambedkar** and **Gandhiji**.

Gandhiji didn't sign this Pact. On 24th September, 1932 A.D. Poona Pact was signed between **Dr. Ambedkar** from Dalit section and **Madan Mohan Malaviya** from Hindu community.

*M.R. Jaykar, Devdas Gandhi, P. Balu, Gawai, Thakkar, Solanki, T.B. Sapru, G.D. Birla, Rajgopalchari, Dr. Rajendra Prasad, Rao Bahadur Srinivas, M.C. Rajah, C.V. Mehta, Bakhle and Kamat signed this Pact too. *71 seats were reserved for Dalits in Communal Award which was increased to 148 by Poona Pact (Madras-30, Sindh with Bombay - 15, Punjab - 8, Bihar and Orissa - 18, Central Province - 20, Assam - 7, Bengal -30 and United Province 20). This number is however 147 in some books. Also, 18% of General seats were reserved for the Dalits in central legislature. After the **Poona Pact**, Gandhiji didn't show any interest in the Civil Disobedience Movement and shifted his total focus towards the fight against

untouchability. He founded **All India Anti Untouchability League** which was later renamed '**Harijan Sevak Sangh**'. **Ghanshyam Das Birla** was its first President.

All India Depressed Classes League was founded by Babu Jagjivan Ram. All India Scheduled Caste Federation was founded by B.R. Ambedkar in 1942 A.D., while All India Depressed Classes Association was founded in 1926 A.D. by M.C. Rajah. On **14th August, 1931 A.D.**, B.R. Ambedkar in a conversation with Gandhiji said that Mahatma Gandhi like fleeting phantoms, raises dust but not level.

1. **Who among the following issued the 'Communal Award'?**

- (a) Ramsay Macdonald (b) Stanley Baldwin
(c) Neville Chamberlain (d) Winston Churchill

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

No consensus was made on the subject of separate electorate for depressed classes and various communities in Second Round Table Conference. British Prime Minister Ramsay MacDonald was authorized for the solution of conflicts in the Conference. Accordingly, Ramsay Macdonald declared his "Communal Award" on 16 Aug. 1932 A.D.

2. **A separate electoral group was made by the communal Tribunal of Ramsay MacDonald first time in August, 1932–**

- (a) for Muslims (b) for Indian Christians
(c) for Anglo-Indians (d) for Untouchables

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (d)

British Prime Minister Ramsay MacDonald announced Communal Award on 16 August 1932 A.D. According to Legislative Assembly provisions, few seats of Legislative Assembly were reserved for minorities whose candidates were to be elected by separate electorates. Muslims and Sikhs were already considered minorities. Now the depressed, Dalits (untouchables) were to be declared minorities as per provisions of the new law.

3. **Consider the statements :**

Assertion (A) : The British Government announced the Communal Award in August 1932.

Reason (R) : It allowed to each minority a number of seats in the legislature to be elected on the basis of a separate electorate.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.

(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

U.P.R.O. /A.R.O. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

4. Which were not allocated separate electorates and reserved seats by Communal Award of MacDonald?

- (a) Muslims (b) Sikhs
(c) Depressed Castes (d) Buddhists

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (d)

British Prime Minister Ramsay MacDonald announced Communal Award on August 16th, 1932 A.D. in which separate electorates were granted not only to Muslims but also to depressed class. In addition to this Indian Christians, Sikhs, Anglo-Indians and others were granted the separate electorates which were applicable only to provincial legislative assemblies. Hence, it is clear that Buddhists were not granted separate electorates.

5. When did Mahatma Gandhi start first fast unto death?

- (a) At the time of Communal Award
(b) At the time of Calcutta Riots
(c) At the time of Jallianwala Bagh Mishap.
(d) At the time of Delhi Riots

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (a)

On September 20, 1932 A.D., Mahatma Gandhi began his first Fast unto death in Yerawada Jail to protest Communal Award of British Prime Minister Ramsay MacDonald. On 24 September, 1932 A.D. Poona Pact was signed between followers of Gandhi and B.R. Ambedkar. After that it was given approved and fast ended on 26 September, 1932 A.D.

6. In August 1932, British Prime Minister announced the scheme for representation of depressed classes. This was called Communal Award. Gandhiji started fast unto death in opposition to this scheme in which jail?

- (a) Ahmednagar Jail (b) Bombay Central Jail
(c) Yerawada Jail (d) None of the above

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

7. Mahatma Gandhi undertook fast unto death in 1932, mainly because :

- (a) Round Table Conference failed to satisfy Indian political aspirations
(b) Congress and Muslim League had a difference of opinion
(c) Ramsay MacDonald announced the Communal Award

(d) None of the statements (a), (b) and (c) given above is correct in this context

I.A.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

8. How many seats were given to depressed classes under Communal Award and Poona Pact?

- (a) 74 and 79 respectively (b) 71 and 147 respectively
(c) 78 and 80 respectively (d) 78 and 69 respectively

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

The number of reserved seats for depressed classes in Provincial Legislatures were 71 in Communal Award which was increased to 148 by Poona Pact (Madras =30, Sindh with Bombay = 15, Punjab = 8, Bihar and Odisha = 18, Central Provinces = 20, Assam= 7, Bengal = 30, United Provinces= 20). Though, some books mention that there are 147 seats. In addition to this, 18% seats in General class seats were reserved for depressed class in Central Legislature.

9. The Poona Pact was concerned with:

- (a) Depressed classes
(b) Hindu-Muslim unity
(c) Constitutional progress
(d) Educational reforms

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2008

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2007

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

10. The purpose of Poona Pact was:

- (a) Hindu-Muslim unity
(b) To provide representation of untouchables
(c) To privileged the Kings
(d) Reconsideration of Dyarchy

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1997

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

11. Assertion (A) : The Poona Pact defeated the purpose of Communal Award.

Reason (R) : It paved the way for reservation of seats in the Parliament and the State Assemblies for the SC and ST people.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
 (b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not a correct explanation of (A).
 (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
 (d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (a)

On 16 August, 1932 A.D., Ramsay Macdonald announced his Communal Award. The award authorised Indian Christians, Muslims, Europeans, Sikhs, depressed classes and others to have separate electorates. Gandhi began fast unto death on 20th September, 1932 A.D. to protest against this decision. Finally, on 24 September, 1932 A.D. an agreement was made in Poona known as 'Poona Pact' in which joint electorate was accepted on the basis of two provisions. The two provisions were – Firstly, there were 148 seats reserved for depressed classes in the provincial legislature while only 71 seats were reserved according to communal award. In Central Legislature 18 percent of the seats allotted to the general electorate were reserved for depressed classes. So reason (R) explains assertion (A) correctly, and both statements are true. So, the option (a) is correct answer.

12. Dr. Ambedkar and Gandhiji had a Pact called :

- (a) Calcutta Pact (b) London Pact
 (c) Poona Pact (d) Lahore Pact

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2007

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Mains) 2002

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

13. Poona Pact was signed between:

- (a) Gandhiji and Lord Irwin
 (b) Gandhiji and Jinnah
 (c) Gandhiji and Subhash Chandra Bose
 (d) Gandhiji and Ambedkar

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (*)

After "fast unto death" of Gandhiji against Communal Award, Poona Pact was signed on 24 September, 1932 A.D. This pact was signed between followers of Gandhiji and Dr. B. R. Ambedkar. Gandhi did not sign on this document.

14. Which among of following was implemented after announcement of "Communal Award".

- (a) Lucknow Pact (b) Karachi Agreement
 (c) Lahore Agreement (d) Poona Pact

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Spl) (Mains) 2010

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

15. Which of the following did not sign on historical Poona Pact of 1932?

- (a) B. R. Ambedkar (b) Madan Mohan Malviya
 (c) C. Rajagopalachari (d) M. K. Gandhi

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (d)

On the day of 24 September, 1932, Poona Pact was signed at 5 O'clock in the evening. Dr. B. R. Ambedkar from depressed classes and Pt. Madan Mohan Malviya from Hindu classes signed the document of Poona Pact. M.M. Jayakar, Devdas Gandhi, Vishwas, Raja Bhoj, P. Balu, Gawai, Thakkar, Solanki, Tej Bahadur Sapru, G. D. Birla, Rajgopalachari, Dr. Rajendra Prasad, Dr. Rao Bahadur Srinivasan, M.C. Rajah, C.V. Mehta, Bakhale and Kamath were other signatories. Many people signed on the document in Bombay. Rajgopalachari changed his pen with Dr. Ambedkar after signing the Poona Pact.

16. After Poona Pact of 1932, Harijan Sewak Sangh was established. Its President was:

- (a) Jagjiwan Ram (b) Ghanshyam Das Birla
 (c) B.R. Ambedkar (d) Amrit Lal Thakkar

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

After Poona Pact, 1932, Mahatma Gandhi was not actively involved in Civil Disobedience Movement but he took an interest in anti-untouchability Movements and "All India Anti-Untouchability League" was founded by Mahatma Gandhi in 1932 AD whose name was later changed to "Harijan Sevak Sangh." Ghanshyam Das Birla was the first President of this institution.

17. Who among the following founded the All India Harijan Sevak Sangh in 1932?

- (a) B.G. Gokhale (b) M.K. Gandhi
 (c) B.R. Ambedkar (d) None of the above

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

18. Who among the following was the first President of all India Anti-Untouchability League (later changed to Harijan Sevak Samaj)?

- (a) B.R. Ambedkar (b) G. D. Birla
 (c) Jyotiba Phule (d) M.K. Gandhi

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.